



Google Workspace Security Checklist

15 checks for small businesses · Steve's IT Pro · stevesitpro.com

The same audit I run with every new client. Work through it in the Admin Console (admin.google.com) and tick each box when it's done. Menu names change from time to time; if a path doesn't match, search the setting name in the Admin Console.

FIX NOW

THIS WEEK

BEST PRACTICE

AUTHENTICATION & ACCESS

- ☐ **1 Enforce 2-Step Verification for all users** **FIX NOW**
Admin Console → Security → Authentication → 2-Step Verification → set to **Enforced**.
The single most important setting. Without it, one leaked password means full account access.
- ☐ **2 Use security keys or passkeys for admin accounts** **FIX NOW**
Admin Console → Security → Authentication → 2-Step Verification → Allowed methods.
Text-message codes can be stolen by SIM swapping. Admins should use a security key or passkey, and never SMS.
- ☐ **3 Limit Super Admins to 2–3 people** **THIS WEEK**
Admin Console → Account → Admin roles → Super Admin → Admins.
Every Super Admin is a high-value target. Give everyone else the narrowest role that does the job.
- ☐ **4 Set a password policy** **THIS WEEK**
Admin Console → Security → Authentication → Password management.
Minimum 12 characters and no password reuse. Length beats complexity rules.
- ☐ **5 Review third-party app access** **THIS WEEK**
Admin Console → Security → Access and data control → API controls → Manage third-party app access.
See which apps can read your company's data. Block anything untrusted.

EMAIL SECURITY

- ☐ **6 Configure SPF, DKIM and DMARC** **FIX NOW**
DNS at your domain host, plus Admin Console → Apps → Google Workspace → Gmail → Authenticate email.
Stops anyone from sending email that looks like it came from your domain.
- ☐ **7 Turn on enhanced pre-delivery scanning** **THIS WEEK**
Admin Console → Apps → Google Workspace → Gmail → Spam, phishing and malware.
Catches phishing that slips past the default filters.
- ☐ **8 Keep email allowlists tight** **THIS WEEK**
Admin Console → Apps → Google Workspace → Gmail → Spam, phishing and malware → Email allowlist.
Allowlisted senders skip spam and phishing checks. List only specific senders you trust, and review quarterly.

DATA PROTECTION

- ☐ **9 Restrict external file sharing** **FIX NOW**
Admin Console → Apps → Google Workspace → Drive and Docs → Sharing settings.
Require sign-in to open shared files, and turn off “Anyone with the link” for sensitive Shared Drives.
- ☐ **10 Keep company files in Shared Drives** **THIS WEEK**
Drive → Shared drives → New.
Files in someone's My Drive leave with them. Shared Drives belong to the company.
- ☐ **11 Enable Google Vault (Business Plus and up)** **BEST PRACTICE**
vault.google.com → Retention.
Set retention rules and recover deleted email and files when you need them.

DEVICES

- ☐ **12 Turn on mobile device management** **THIS WEEK**
Admin Console → Devices → Mobile & endpoints → Settings → Universal settings.
Basic management at minimum, so you can wipe company data from a lost or stolen phone.
- ☐ **13 Require a screen lock on managed devices** **BEST PRACTICE**
Admin Console → Devices → Mobile & endpoints → Settings → Android / iOS settings → Password.
Stops someone who picks up an unlocked phone from reading company email.

MONITORING & RESPONSE

- ☐ **14 Set up admin email alerts** **THIS WEEK**
Admin Console → Security → Alert center → Manage alerts.
Get alerted to suspicious sign-ins, government-backed attack warnings and admin role changes. Send them to an inbox someone reads.
- ☐ **15 Review the audit logs monthly** **BEST PRACTICE**
Admin Console → Reporting → Audit and investigation.
Look for failed sign-ins, unusual sharing and new app authorizations. Fifteen minutes a month catches problems early.

Scoring yourself: if items 1, 2, 6 and 9 are done, you've covered the most serious risks. Items 3–5, 7–8 and 10 come next. The rest hardens your setup and builds good habits.

Want a second pair of eyes? Book a free 30-minute consult and I'll review these settings with you live and tell you exactly what to fix. stevesitpro.com/book · steve@stevesitpro.com